

NAME: _____ CLASS: _____ TEACHER: _____

KEY TOPIC 2 • 1569–1588**Challenges to Elizabeth at Home and Abroad, 1569–88**

HISTORICAL PRIMARY RECORD: The Armada Portrait of Queen Elizabeth I (c. 1588)

WOBURN ABBEY COLLECTION • BEDFORDSHIRE • WA-INV-042

Key topic 2: Challenges to Elizabeth at home and abroad, 1569–88

1 Plots and revolts at home	- The reasons for, and significance of, the Revolt of the Northern Earls, 1569–70. - The features and significance of the Ridolfi, Throckmorton and Babington plots. Walsingham and the use of spies. - The reasons for, and significance of, Mary Queen of Scots' execution in 1587.
2 Relations with Spain	- Political, religious and commercial rivalry. - The significance of privateering and the activities of Drake.
3 Outbreak of war with Spain, 1585–88	- Reasons for deteriorating relations with Spain: English direct involvement in the Netherlands and the actions of Robert Dudley. - Drake and the raid on Cadiz: 'Singeing the King of Spain's beard'.
4 The Armada	- Spanish invasion plans. Key events of the Spanish Armada. - The reasons for the English victory.

LIVING TIMELINE • PART 1: CHRONOLOGICAL ANCHORS (KEY TOPIC 2)

Instructions: As you study each enquiry lesson, complete the timeline missions by sketching and annotating in the corresponding dual-coding sketchpads below.

NOV 1569 • Revolt of the Northern Earls

Key Topic 2.1

Catholic Earls of Northumberland and Westmorland march on Durham Cathedral, tear up English bibles, and restore the Latin Mass with 4,600 men. Royal troops march north; the rebellion collapses and Elizabeth executes 450 rebels to crush northern disobedience.

FEB 1570 • Papal Bull *Regnans in Excelsis*

Key Topic 2.1

Pope Pius V issues a papal bull excommunicating Elizabeth, declaring her a 'pretended queen' and heretic. Crucially, the Pope releases all Catholic subjects from their oath of allegiance, making it a sacred Catholic duty to overthrow the Queen.

1571–1583 • The Ridolfi and Throckmorton Plots

Key Topic 2.1

Italian banker Roberto Ridolfi plans a Spanish invasion by the Duke of Alba to marry Mary to the Duke of Norfolk. In 1583, French Catholic Francis Throckmorton coordinates a planned invasion backed by Spain and the Pope. Walsingham uncovers both.

LIVING TIMELINE • PART 2: CHRONOLOGICAL ANCHORS (KEY TOPIC 2)

Instructions: Complete the dual-coding sketches to permanently anchor these chronological turning points in long-term memory.

AUG 1585 • The Treaty of Nonsuch & Open War with Spain

Key Topic 2.3

Following the assassination of Dutch Protestant leader William of Orange, Elizabeth signs the Treaty of Nonsuch with Dutch rebels, agreeing to send 7,400 troops under Robert Dudley. This ends decades of cold war and triggers open military conflict with Spain.

1586–FEB 1587 • The Babington Plot & Execution of Mary Stuart

Key Topic 2.1

Anthony Babington sends coded letters in beer barrels to Mary Stuart agreeing to assassinate Elizabeth. Walsingham's codebreaker Thomas Phelippes intercepts Mary's endorsement. Mary is convicted of high treason and beheaded at Fotheringhay Castle on 8 Feb 1587.

APR 1587–AUG 1588 • Drake at Cadiz & Defeat of the Spanish Armada

Key Topic 2.4

Drake raids Cadiz harbour, destroying 30 Spanish ships ('singeing the King's beard') and delaying the Armada by a year. In July 1588, 130 Spanish ships enter the Channel. English fireships break their formation at Calais; Gravelines artillery seals English victory.

Why did every Catholic plot to assassinate Elizabeth end in catastrophic failure?

CHRONOLOGICAL INQUIRY SPINE • CORE CAUSAL NARRATIVE

Take precise, structured notes alongside each milestone as your teacher narrates the history

1 NOV 1569–JAN 1570

The Revolt of the Northern Earls

- Earls of Northumberland and Westmorland rebel to restore Catholic worship
- Rebels take Durham Cathedral, celebrate Catholic Mass, and march south
- Royal army of 14,000 under Earl of Sussex marches north; the earls flee to Scotland
- Elizabeth orders the execution of over 450 rebels to deter further uprisings

FOCUS CLUE

Why did the Northern Earls fail to gain widespread support across England?

2 1570–1571

Papal Bull & The Ridolfi Plot

- Feb 1570: Pope Pius V issues Papal Bull excommunicating Elizabeth from Church
- 1571: Italian banker Roberto Ridolfi plans Spanish invasion and Norfolk-Mary marriage
- Philip II and Duke of Alba agree to send 10,000 troops; plot uncovered by William Cecil
- June 1572: Duke of Norfolk executed for treason; Ridolfi remains abroad

FOCUS CLUE

How did the 1570 Papal Bull turn English Catholics into suspected traitors?

3 1583–1584

The Throckmorton Plot & Bond of Association

- French Duke of Guise plots invasion to overthrow Elizabeth and free Mary Stuart
- Philip II offers financial help and the Pope approves the invasion plan
- Francis Throckmorton arrested by Walsingham; papers expose Spanish ambassador Mendoza
- 1584: Privy Council drafts Bond of Association to execute anyone plotting against Elizabeth

FOCUS CLUE

Why did the Throckmorton Plot lead to the expulsion of the Spanish ambassador?

4 1586

The Babington Plot & Walsingham's Spies

- Anthony Babington plots to assassinate Elizabeth with foreign Catholic backing
- Letters hidden inside beer barrels are smuggled to Mary at Chartley Manor
- Walsingham's codebreaker Thomas Phelippes decodes letters showing Mary agreed to plot
- Babington and six conspirators executed for treason in September 1586

FOCUS CLUE

How did Walsingham use codebreaking and informers to trap Mary?

5 FEB 1587

The Execution of Mary, Queen of Scots

- October 1586: Mary tried at Fotheringhay Castle under the Act for the Queen's Safety
- Found guilty of treason; Parliament and Privy Council demand her immediate death
- Elizabeth hesitates for months, fearing the precedent of executing an anointed monarch
- 8 Feb 1587: Mary executed at Fotheringhay; outrages Spain and Catholic Europe

FOCUS CLUE

Why was Elizabeth so reluctant to sign Mary Queen of Scots' death warrant?

Question 1: Describe Two Features [2 × 2 marks • 6 mins]

Total Score: [/ 4]

• QUESTION 1(A): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

★ HIGH PROBABILITY

Edexcel June 2018 (Q1b)

Describe one key feature of the Revolt of the Northern Earls (1569).

Target Guidance: Point (A Catholic uprising led by the Earls of Northumberland and Westmorland to restore Catholicism) • Fact (They held a Latin Mass in Durham Cathedral with 4,600 men, but fled when royal troops advanced; 450 rebels were executed).

Sentence Stems: One key feature was the northern Catholic nobles' attempt to overthrow Protestantism... Specifically, they captured Durham Cathedral and...

• QUESTION 1(B): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

RECENT EXAM BOARD
FOCUSEdexcel June 2023
(Q1b)

Describe one key feature of Sir Francis Walsingham's spy network.

Target Guidance: Point (An extensive intelligence network of spies, informers, codebreakers, and cryptographers) • Fact (Walsingham intercepted letters, cracked ciphers with Thomas Phelippes, and deployed double agents across England and Europe).

Sentence Stems: One key feature was Walsingham's systematic interception of secret communications... Specifically, his cryptographer Thomas Phelippes...

• CORE SPECIFICATION VOCABULARY DISTINCTION

PEARSON EDEXCEL SPECIFICATION

Explain the difference between an official written order issued by the Pope (**Papal Bull**) and a secret agreement between people to overthrow or kill the Queen (**Conspiracy**):

Sentence Starter: While Papal Bull refers specifically to..., Conspiracy operated differently because...

TIMELINE MISSION • PAGES 2–3

[] Sketch Completed

Turn to Pages 2–3 (Milestone 5). In Milestone 5, sketch the beer barrel with hidden cipher letters and the execution block at Fotheringhay.

Optional Draft Sketchpad • Practice your visual dual-coding icon before transferring to Pages 2–3

Continued

INDEPENDENT TIMED RESPONSE • FINAL HISTORICAL

[illegible]

Was war between England and Spain inevitable from the moment Elizabeth took the throne?

CHRONOLOGICAL INQUIRY SPINE • CORE CAUSAL NARRATIVE

Take precise, structured notes alongside each milestone as your teacher narrates the history

11570–1577 Political and Religious Rivalry with Spain - Philip II sees Protestant England as a threat to Catholic authority in Europe - Elizabeth aids Dutch Protestant rebels with covert funds and safe ports for Sea Beggars 1572: Elizabeth expels Sea Beggars; they capture Brill, sparking wider Dutch revolt - English cloth trade through Antwerp disrupted, harming merchant livelihoods FOCUS CLUE Why did the Spanish presence in the Netherlands threaten English trade and security?	
21570–1579 Commercial Rivalry in the New World - Spain claims monopoly over trade and wealth in the Americas - English merchants denied trade licenses by Spanish authorities - English sailors turn to illegal trade and attacking Spanish treasure fleets 1572: Francis Drake raids Nombre de Dios in Panama, capturing £20,000 in silver FOCUS CLUE Why did English privateering anger King Philip II of Spain?	
31577–1580 Drake's Circumnavigation - Drake sails Golden Hind into the Pacific; raids Spanish ports in Chile and Peru - Captures treasure ship Cacafuego carrying 80lb of gold and 26 tons of silver - Explores California (Nova Albion); trades for cloves with Sultan of Ternate - Returns to Plymouth in Sept 1580 with £140,000 in treasure, enriching the Crown FOCUS CLUE Why did Drake's Pacific raid represent a direct challenge to the Spanish Empire?	
41581–1584 Escalation & Elizabeth's Defiance - April 1581: Elizabeth publicly knights Drake on the Golden Hind at Deptford - Philip II furious that Elizabeth rewarded a man Spain viewed as a common pirate 1580: Philip II inherits the crown of Portugal, gaining its navy and empire 1584: French Duke of Alençon and Dutch rebel leader William the Silent both die FOCUS CLUE Why did Elizabeth's knighting of Drake make war with Spain more likely?	
51584–1585 The Treaties of Joinville & Nonsuch - Dec 1584: Philip II signs Treaty of Joinville with French Catholics to fight Protestantism - English government fears combined French and Spanish Catholic invasion - Aug 1585: Elizabeth signs Treaty of Nonsuch, sending 7,400 English soldiers to Netherlands - Oct 1585: Drake dispatched to raid Spanish ports in Vigo and the Caribbean FOCUS CLUE How did the Treaty of Nonsuch mark the beginning of direct war with Spain?	

Question 1: Describe Two Features [2 × 2 marks • 6 mins]

Total Score: [/ 4]

• QUESTION 1(A): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

MEDIUM FREQUENCY

Edexcel June 2019 (Q1a)

Describe one key feature of commercial rivalry between England and Spain in the New World.

Target Guidance: Point (Spain held an exclusive trade monopoly on its American colonies that barred English merchants) • Fact (English privateers like John Hawkins and Drake bypassed Spanish licenses to trade illegally and seize Spanish bullion ships).

Sentence Stems: One key feature was Spanish trade restrictions in the Caribbean... Specifically, Spain banned English merchants, prompting privateers like Drake to...

• QUESTION 1(B): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

CORE SPECIFICATION
FOCUSEdexcel November 2021
(Q1b)

Describe one key feature of Sir Francis Drake's raid on the Cacafuego (1579).

Target Guidance: Point (Drake captured Spain's richest treasure galleon in the Pacific during his circumnavigation) • Fact (He seized 80lb of gold, 26 tons of silver, and jewels worth £140,000, bringing it back to Elizabeth on the Golden Hind).

Sentence Stems: One key feature was the colossal value of the treasure seized... Specifically, Drake intercepted the treasure ship off Ecuador and took...

• CORE SPECIFICATION VOCABULARY DISTINCTION

PEARSON EDEXCEL SPECIFICATION

Explain the difference between an armed sailor licensed by the Queen to capture enemy ships (**Privateer**) and a government ban that stops all trade with another nation (**Trade Embargo**):

Sentence Starter: While Privateer refers specifically to..., Trade Embargo operated differently because...

TIMELINE MISSION • PAGES 2–3

[] Sketch Completed

Turn to Pages 2–3 (Milestone 3). In Milestone 3, sketch Drake's ship the *Golden Hind* and the Spanish silver bars.

Optional Draft Sketchpad • Practice your visual dual-coding icon before transferring to Pages 2–3

Question 3: Evaluative Essay [16 marks + 4 SPaG • 25 mins]

EDEXCEL JUNE 2023
(Q3A)

**CORE EXAM
FOCUS**

Score: [/
20]

‘Commercial rivalry in the Americas was the main cause of worsening relations between England and Spain between 1569 and 1585.’ How far do you agree? Explain your answer.

You may use in your answer: • Francis Drake's privateering • Religious conflict *(You must also use information of your own.)*

1. CRITERIA 1: COMMERCIAL RIVALRY & DRAKE

POINT 1

Explain how Drake's raids in the West Indies and Pacific humiliated Philip II; by knighting Drake in 1581 and funding privateers, Elizabeth demonstrated state sponsorship of piracy against Spanish bullion.

2. CRITERIA 2: RELIGIOUS ANTAGONISM

POINT 2

Explain that Philip viewed himself as the secular sword of the Catholic Counter-Reformation; the 1570 papal bull excommunicating Elizabeth and Philip's backing of plots (Ridolfi, Throckmorton) made holy war inevitable.

3. CRITERIA 3: THE STRATEGIC NETHERLANDS CRISIS

**POINT
3**

Explain that Spain's military brutality in the Netherlands (Alba and Parma) threatened England's chief wool export market; Spanish control of Channel ports was an intolerable direct invasion threat.

Analytical Connectives: Commercial rivalry was an explosive cause of hostility because... • Specifically, Drake's plundering of Spanish galleons directly attacked Philip's treasury and prestige... • However, religious divisions deepened the clash because Philip believed... • Furthermore, the strategic geopolitical crisis in the Netherlands was arguably more urgent because... • Weighing these factors, I conclude that while commercial piracy provoked constant anger, the Netherlands crisis was the decisive trigger because...

Word Bank: Commercial rivalry • Privateers • Francis Drake • *Golden Hind* • *Cacafuego* • Philip II • Netherlands • Papal Bull (1570) • Counter-Reformation

Task: Using the structure strip above, write your analytical response below (continue on facing page for full timed response):

[illegible]

Continued

VERDICT

[illegible]

Did English intervention in the Netherlands or Drake’s raid on Cadiz make the Armada inevitable?

CHRONOLOGICAL INQUIRY SPINE • CORE CAUSAL NARRATIVE		Take precise, structured notes alongside each milestone as your teacher narrates the history
1 DEC 1585–1586 Dudley’s Campaign in the Netherlands - Robert Dudley, Earl of Leicester, leads 7,400 English soldiers to the Netherlands - Dudley accepts title of ‘Governor-General’ of Low Countries, angering Elizabeth - English forces slow Duke of Parma’s advance but fail to take the deep-water port of Flushing - Quarrels between English commanders and Dutch rebels hinder military cooperation FOCUS CLUE Why did Dudley’s acceptance of the title ‘Governor-General’ anger Elizabeth? 2 1586–1587 Military Setbacks: Zutphen & Deventer - Sept 1586: Sir Philip Sidney killed at the Battle of Zutphen - Jan 1587: English commander Sir William Stanley betrays town of Deventer to Spain - Betrayals lead Dutch rebels to lose confidence in English leadership - Dudley recalled to England in late 1587; English intervention prevented total Dutch defeat FOCUS CLUE Why did English military intervention in the Netherlands struggle to achieve success? 3 APRIL 1587 Drake’s Raid on Cadiz - April 1587: Elizabeth orders Drake to disrupt Spanish Armada preparations - Drake sails directly into Cadiz harbor; destroys 30 Spanish ships and tons of supplies - Raids the coast of Portugal; destroys thousands of tons of seasoned wooden barrel staves - Captures rich Portuguese treasure ship San Felipe on his return journey FOCUS CLUE How did Drake’s raid on Cadiz delay the launch of the Spanish Armada? 4 1587–1588 Impact of the Cadiz Raid - Loss of seasoned wood forced Spaniards to use unseasoned wood for food and water barrels - Fresh water and food spoiled quickly aboard the Armada, causing sickness and disease - Armada delayed by over a year, giving England vital time to prepare coastal defenses - Spain’s leading admiral Santa Cruz dies; replaced by Duke of Medina Sidonia FOCUS CLUE Why was the destruction of wooden barrel staves fatal to the Armada? 5 MAY–JULY 1588 The Armada Sets Sail - May 1588: Armada of 130 ships and 30,000 men departs Lisbon under Medina Sidonia - Hit by storms; forced to stop at Corunna for repairs and supplies - Warning beacons lit along the English coast as Armada sighted off the Lizard in July - Plan: sail up Channel, join with Parma’s 27,000 soldiers, and invade England FOCUS CLUE What were the main strengths and weaknesses of Philip II’s invasion plan?		

Question 1: Describe Two Features [2 × 2 marks • 6 mins]

Total Score: [/ 4]

• QUESTION 1(A): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

CORE SPECIFICATION
FOCUSEdexcel June 2022
(Q1a)

Describe one key feature of the Treaty of Nonsuch (1585).

Target Guidance: Point (An official military alliance committing England to support Dutch Protestant rebels against Spain) • Fact (Elizabeth sent 7,400 soldiers under the Earl of Leicester and financed their campaign, officially ending covert neutrality).

Sentence Stems: One key feature was England's formal military commitment to the Dutch rebels... Specifically, Elizabeth agreed to send...

• QUESTION 1(B): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

★ HIGH PROBABILITY (Not examined since 2019)

Edexcel June 2019
(Q1b)

Describe one key feature of Francis Drake's raid on Cadiz in 1587.

Target Guidance: Point (A surprise pre-emptive attack on Spain's primary naval staging base at Cadiz) • Fact (Drake destroyed 30 Spanish warships and tons of seasoned barrel staves, delaying the sailing of the Armada by over 12 months).

Sentence Stems: One key feature was the devastating destruction of Spanish naval shipping... Specifically, Drake sailed directly into Cadiz harbour and...

• CORE SPECIFICATION VOCABULARY DISTINCTION

PEARSON EDEXCEL SPECIFICATION

Explain the difference between England's treaty promising direct military troops to Dutch rebels (**Treaty of Nonsuch**) and Drake's surprise naval attack that delayed the Spanish Armada (**Raid on Cadiz**):

Sentence Starter: While Treaty of Nonsuch refers specifically to..., Raid on Cadiz operated differently because...

TIMELINE MISSION • PAGES 2–3

[] Sketch Completed

Turn to Pages 2–3 (Milestone 4). In Milestone 4, sketch the Dutch Protestant rebel banner and the Treaty of Nonsuch seal.

Optional Draft Sketchpad • Practice your visual dual-coding icon before transferring to Pages 2–3

Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 18 mins]

**EDEXCEL NOVEMBER 2020
(Q2)**

★ HIGH-YIELD FORECAST

Score: [/ 12]

Explain why Elizabeth signed the Treaty of Nonsuch with Dutch rebels in 1585.

You may use in your answer:

- The assassination of William of Orange

- The Treaty of Joinville

(You must also use information of your own.)

1. CAUSE 1: ASSASSINATION OF WILLIAM OF ORANGE

POINT
1

Explain that the murder of William the Silent in July 1584 left the Dutch rebellion leaderless and facing total collapse; if the Dutch fell, Parma's veteran Spanish army would turn directly on England.

2. CAUSE 2: THE TREATY OF JOINVILLE & ISOLATION

POINT
2

Explain that in Dec 1584 Spain and France signed the Treaty of Joinville, uniting the two Catholic superpowers; England faced total diplomatic encirclement and could no longer play France off against Spain.

3. CAUSE 3: STRATEGIC CONTROL OF CHANNEL PORTS

**POINT
3**

Explain that deep-water Dutch ports like Antwerp, Flushing, and Brill lay directly opposite the Thames estuary; Elizabeth had to secure these ports to prevent an invasion springboard into southern England.

Analytical Connectives: Elizabeth signed the Treaty of Nonsuch primarily because... • Crucially, the sudden assassination of William of Orange meant that... • This danger was intensified by the Treaty of Joinville, which... • Furthermore, from a military standpoint, controlling Dutch Channel ports was vital because... • Consequently, Elizabeth was forced to abandon covert diplomacy and declare open military commitment because...

Word Bank: Treaty of Nonsuch • William of Orange • Treaty of Joinville • Robert Dudley • Duke of Parma • Netherlands • Army of Flanders • Flushing • Channel ports

Task: Using the structure strip above, write your analytical response below (continue on facing page for full timed response):

[illegible]

Enquiry 2.3: Outbreak of war with Spain, 1585–88 • Question 2 Continued INDEPENDENT TIMED RESPONSE • FINAL HISTORICAL VERDICT

**INDEPENDENT TIMED RESPONSE • FINAL
HISTORICAL VERDICT**

[illegible]

Why did the Spanish Armada fail: superior English tactics or disastrous Spanish planning?

CHRONOLOGICAL INQUIRY SPINE • CORE CAUSAL NARRATIVE

Take precise, structured notes alongside each milestone as your teacher narrates the history

1 JULY 1588 Channel Battles: Plymouth to Isle of Wight • 130 Spanish ships advance up the English Channel in a tight defensive crescent • English fleet under Howard and Drake pursues, firing from long range • Medina Sidonia aims to anchor off Isle of Wight to await news from Parma • English warships out-maneuver Spanish ships and prevent them finding safe anchorage FOCUS CLUE Why did the Armada's tight crescent formation make it difficult to attack?	
2 7–8 AUG 1588 Calais Roads & The Fireships • 6 August: Armada anchors off Calais; Parma's army not ready due to Dutch blockade • Midnight, 7 August: English send eight blazing fireships into crowded Spanish fleet • Spanish captains panic, cut their anchor cables, and scatter into the North Sea • Defensive crescent formation broken; ships drift toward shallow sandbanks FOCUS CLUE Why was the use of fireships at Calais the decisive turning point?	
3 8 AUG 1588 The Battle of Gravelines • English ships close to within 100 meters of scattered Spanish vessels • English cannons mounted on small carriages fire rapidly into wooden hulls • Spanish heavy cannons on unwieldy carriages cannot reload quickly • Three Spanish ships sunk; over 1,000 Spaniards killed; fleet heavily damaged FOCUS CLUE How did English ship design and gunnery win the Battle of Gravelines?	
4 AUG–SEPT 1588 The Winds & Atlantic Retreat • South-westerly winds blow battered Armada north into treacherous Scottish waters • Lacking anchors and fresh water, Spanish ships attempt to sail around Scotland and Ireland • Fierce storms wreck over 40 Spanish ships on the rocky coasts of Scotland and Ireland • Only 67 of 130 ships return to Spain; thousands of Spanish sailors die FOCUS CLUE Why did the loss of anchors and clean water lead to disaster in the Atlantic?	
5 1588–1589 Consequences of the English Victory • Elizabeth celebrated as a great Protestant monarch; delivered speech at Tilbury • Proved English naval strength could defend the country and challenge Spain • Protestantism in England and the Netherlands survived Spanish invasion • Philip II's prestige damaged, though war with Spain continued for 16 years FOCUS CLUE Why did the defeat of the Armada boost English national confidence?	

Question 1: Describe Two Features [2 × 2 marks • 6 mins]

Total Score: [/ 4]

• QUESTION 1(A): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

MEDIUM
FREQUENCYEdexcel November 2020
(Q1b)

Describe one key feature of the Spanish invasion plan of 1588.

Target Guidance: Point (A joint operation requiring the Armada to rendezvous with the Duke of Parma's army in the Netherlands) • Fact (Medina Sidonia had to transport Parma's 27,000 veteran soldiers across the Channel on flat-bottomed barges to invade Kent).

Sentence Stems: One key feature was the coordination required between fleet and army... Specifically, Medina Sidonia was ordered to rendezvous with Parma at...

• QUESTION 1(B): DESCRIBE ONE KEY FEATURE [2 MARKS • 3 MINS]

RECENT EXAM BOARD
FOCUSEdexcel June 2024
(Q1a)

Describe one key feature of the English fireship attack at Calais (7 August 1588).

Target Guidance: Point (Eight burning ships filled with pitch and gunpowder were launched into the anchored Spanish fleet) • Fact (Spanish captains panicked, cut their anchor cables, and broke their defensive crescent formation, scattering into the open sea).

Sentence Stems: One key feature was the psychological panic caused by the fireships... Specifically, Spanish captains cut their anchors and broke...

• CORE SPECIFICATION VOCABULARY DISTINCTION

PEARSON EDEXCEL SPECIFICATION

Explain the difference between a large, heavily armed warship designed for ocean fighting (**Galleon**) and burning vessels sent into the Spanish fleet to cause panic and scatter their formation (**Fireships**):

Sentence Starter: While Galleon refers specifically to..., Fireships operated differently because...

TIMELINE MISSION • PAGES 2–3

[] Sketch Completed

Turn to Pages 2–3 (Milestone 6). In Milestone 6, sketch the blazing fireships drifting into Calais Roads and the shattered Spanish galleon.

Optional Draft Sketchpad • Practice your visual dual-coding icon before transferring to Pages 2–3

Question 3: Evaluative Essay [16 marks + 4 SPaG • 25 mins]

**EDEXCEL JUNE 2019
(Q3B)**

★ HIGH-YIELD
FORECAST

Score: [/
20]

'The English defeated the Spanish Armada mainly because of superior English naval tactics and technology.' How far do you agree? Explain your answer.

You may use in your answer:

- English fireships at Calais
- Spanish planning and leadership

(You must also use information of your own.)

1. CRITERIA 1: ENGLISH TACTICS & SHIP DESIGN

POINT
1

Explain how Hawkins' race-built galleons outmaneuvered clumsy Spanish carracks, using long-range culverins on four-wheeled truck carriages to reload and fire broadsides rapidly at Gravelines.

2. CRITERIA 2: FLAWED SPANISH INVASION PLANNING

POINT
2

Explain that Philip II's plan was fatally flawed: Parma controlled no deep-water port in the Netherlands, meaning communication took 48 hours by horse and barges could not escape Dutch flyboat blockades.

3. CRITERIA 3: ADVERSE WEATHER & THE "PROTESTANT WIND"	POL 3
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POINT
3

Explain that south-westerly gales drove the scattered Spanish fleet into the hazardous North Sea; lacking anchors lost at Calais, dozens of galleons were wrecked on the jagged rocks of Scotland and Ireland.

Analytical Connectives: Superior English tactics and ship design were pivotal because... • Specifically, the deployment of fireships at Calais succeeded in... • Furthermore, at the Battle of Gravelines, English culverins... • However, Spanish structural blunders critically undermined the operation because... • Ultimately, while bad weather completed the destruction, English naval technology was the decisive factor because...

Word Bank: Spanish Armada • Medina Sidonia • Duke of Parma • Race-built galleons • Culverins • Crescent formation • Calais fireships • Battle of Gravelines • Protestant Wind

Task: Using the structure strip above, write your analytical response below (continue on facing page for full timed response):

[illegible]

Enquiry 2.4: The Armada • Question 3 Continued

INDEPENDENT TIMED RESPONSE • FINAL HISTORICAL VERDICT

[illegible]

"Sustained conclusion: explain why the Protestant Wind finished what English gunnery started."

NAVAL TACTICS & STRATEGIC MAP • THE SPANISH ARMADA (1588)

1. THE STRATEGIC ROUTE OF THE ARMADA: PLYMOUTH TO GRAVELINES & THE ATLANTIC RETREAT			
① The Channel (July): 130 Spanish ships in tight crescent formation sail past Plymouth and the Isle of Wight. English long-range fire inflicts minor damage.	② Calais Roads (7 Aug): Armada anchors waiting for Parma. Midnight English fireships scatter Spanish fleet, forcing captains to cut anchor cables.	③ Gravelines (8 Aug): Close-range artillery duel. English race-built galleons pummel drifting Spanish ships with rapid-fire culverins; 5 galleons sunk.	④ The Retreat (Aug–Sept): South-westerly gales drive Armada around Scotland and Ireland. Lacking anchors, over 40 ships wreck on Atlantic reefs.
2. NAVAL ARCHITECTURE: HAWKINS' RACE-BUILT GALLEON VS THE SPANISH IMPERIAL CARRACK			
GB English Race-Built Galleon (*Revenge*, *Ark Royal*) • Designer: Sir John Hawkins (Treasurer of the Navy) • Hull Design: Lower forecastles and aftercastles; streamlined hull for superior speed, maneuverability, and pointing into the wind • Armament: Armed with long-range bronze culverins mounted on compact four-wheeled truck carriages • Gunnery Doctrine: Trained gun crews could reload and fire broadsides rapidly from standoff range, avoiding boarding combat • Tactical Goal: Batter enemy hulls and rigging from safe artillery distance		ES Spanish Imperial Galleon / Carrack (*San Martín*) • Commander: Duke of Medina Sidonia • Hull Design: High towering wooden forecastles and sterncastles designed as floating wooden fortresses for infantry • Armament: Heavy short-range cannon and demi-cannon mounted on clumsy two-wheeled field carriages • Gunnery Doctrine: Soldiers fired muskets from high castles while gunners reloaded outside ship hulls (extremely slow) • Tactical Goal: Grapple enemy ships, board with veteran Spanish infantry, and capture vessels in hand-to-hand combat	

MASTER KNOWLEDGE ORGANISER • KEY TOPIC 2: CHALLENGES TO ELIZABETH AT HOME AND ABROAD, 1569–88

1. CORE DISCIPLINARY VOCABULARY & CONCEPTUAL DEFINITIONS

- **Papal Bull (1570):** *Regnans in Excelsis*: Pope Pius V excommunicated Elizabeth, releasing subjects from loyalty.
- **Bond of Association (1584):** Pledge by Englishmen to execute anyone involved in an assassination attempt against Elizabeth.
- **Singeing the King's Beard:** Drake's April 1587 raid on Cadiz harbour destroying 30 ships and delaying the Armada by a year.
- **Culverin:** Long-range English bronze naval cannon mounted on truck carriages for rapid reloading.
- **Privateering:** State-licensed raiding of enemy merchant shipping by armed private vessels holding letters of marque.
- **Treaty of Nonsuch (1585):** Official military alliance committing 7,400 English soldiers under Robert Dudley to aid Dutch rebels.
- **Galleon:** A large, multi-decked warship designed for ocean navigation and long-range cannon fire.
- **Battle of Gravelines (1588):** Decisive naval clash off Flanders where English artillery battered scattered Spanish warships.

2. ESSENTIAL CHRONOLOGY

- 1569: Revolt of the Northern Earls
- 1570: Papal Bull excommunicates Queen
- 1571: Ridolfi Plot uncovered
- 1577–80: Drake circumnavigates world
- 1583: Throckmorton Plot uncovered
- 1584: Treaty of Joinville (Spain/France)
- 1585: Treaty of Nonsuch signed
- 1586: Babington Plot ciphers cracked
- Feb 1587: Mary Stuart executed
- July–Aug 1588: Spanish Armada defeated

3. KEY HISTORICAL FIGURES MATRIX

- **Sir Francis Walsingham:** Principal Secretary & Spymaster General; uncovered Ridolfi, Throckmorton, and Babington plots.
- **Sir Francis Drake:** Privateer, navigator, and vice-admiral; raided Cadiz in 1587 and commanded at Gravelines.
- **Duke of Medina Sidonia:** Spanish grandee appointed by Philip II to command the 130 ships of the Armada.
- **Duke of Parma:** Brilliant general commanding Spain's 27,000-man veteran Army of Flanders.
- **Anthony Babington:** Catholic gentleman whose coded letters to Mary Stuart triggered her trial and execution.
- **Sir John Hawkins:** Treasurer of the Navy; designed English race-built galleons and developed naval gunnery.

Cumulative Specification Recall: Enquiries 2.1 & 2.2

Classroom Protocol: Complete 5–10 questions as a Do Now bell-ringer at the start of each lesson, or quiz yourself across the term. Tick the review checkboxes (R1, R2, R3) after each spaced retrieval attempt.

ENQUIRY 2.1: PLOTS AND REVOLTS AT HOME [/ 10] 1. Which two northern Catholic earls led the 1569 rebellion? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3 2. Which Catholic cathedral did the Northern Earls seize to celebrate the Latin Mass? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3 3. What papal bull excommunicated Elizabeth I in 1570? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3 4. Which English duke was executed in 1572 for his role in the Ridolfi Plot? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3 5. Who was Queen Elizabeth’s Spymaster General from 1573? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3 6. How did plotters smuggle coded messages to Mary Stuart during the Babington Plot? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3 7. What skilled cryptographer decoded Mary Stuart’s letters for Walsingham? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3 8. What 1584 document pledged to execute anyone who attempted to assassinate Elizabeth? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3 9. In which castle was Mary, Queen of Scots beheaded on 8 February 1587? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3 10. Approximately how many northern rebels did Elizabeth execute after the 1569 revolt? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3	ENQUIRY 2.2: RELATIONS WITH SPAIN [/ 10] 11. Which Spanish king had previously been married to Elizabeth’s sister Mary I? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3 12. What religion was Philip II, positioning himself as champion of the Counter-Reformation? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3 13. What Spanish monopoly prohibited English merchants from trading in the Americas? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3 14. What term describes state-licensed sea captains who raided enemy merchant ships? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3 15. Which English privateer became the first to circumnavigate the globe (1577–80)? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3 16. What famous Spanish treasure ship was captured by Drake off Ecuador in 1579? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3 17. How much silver and treasure did Drake capture from the *Cacafuego*? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3 18. Where did Elizabeth publicly knight Francis Drake in 1581? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3 19. Why was Philip II enraged by Elizabeth knightng Francis Drake? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3 20. What Dutch territory revolted against Philip II’s rule in 1566? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3
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Cumulative Specification Recall: Enquiries 2.3 & 2.4

Spaced Retention Target: Test yourself on previous weeks' topics before starting a new enquiry. Frequent low-stakes retrieval prevents forgetting and secures Level 4 factual precision.

ENQUIRY 2.3: OUTBREAK OF WAR WITH SPAIN, 1585–88

[/ 10]

21. Which Dutch Protestant leader was assassinated by a Catholic fanatic in 1584? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3

22. What treaty between Philip II and the French Catholic League was signed in 1584? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3

23. What 1585 treaty committed English troops to fight alongside Dutch rebels? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3

24. Who was appointed commander of the 7,400 English soldiers sent to the Netherlands? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3

25. What controversial political title did Robert Dudley accept in the Netherlands, outraging Elizabeth? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3

26. Which brilliant Spanish general commanded the Army of Flanders in the Netherlands? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3

27. In which Spanish harbour did Francis Drake launch a daring surprise raid in April 1587? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3

28. How many Spanish ships did Drake destroy in Cadiz harbour in 36 hours? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3

29. What famous phrase described Drake's raid on Cadiz? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3

30. What vital naval supplies did Drake destroy at Cadiz that crippled the Armada's food storage? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3

ENQUIRY 2.4: THE ARMADA

[/ 10]

31. How many ships sailed in the Spanish Armada in May 1588? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3

32. Who was appointed Commander-in-Chief of the Spanish Armada by Philip II? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3

33. What veteran Spanish army in the Netherlands was the Armada supposed to collect? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3

34. Who served as Lord High Admiral commanding the English fleet in 1588? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3

35. What naval treasurer revolutionized English galleon design with lower forecastles? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3

36. What long-range naval cannon allowed English ships to bombard Spanish galleons from safety? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3

37. What defensive formation did the Spanish Armada maintain sailing up the Channel? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3

38. What terrifying tactic did the English use at midnight on 7 August off Calais? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3

39. What decisive naval battle was fought on 8 August 1588 off the Flemish coast? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3

40. What route were the surviving Spanish ships forced to take back to Spain? [] R1 [] R2 [] R3

THE HISTORY DEPARTMENT • ASSESSMENT & PROGRESS RECORD

KEY TOPIC 2 ASSESSMENT & PROGRESS RECORD

PUPIL: 	TARGET GRADE:	PREDICTED:	ATTITUDE: 1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5
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#	ENQUIRY / LESSON ASSESSMENT	DO NOW (10M)	Q1(A) (2M)	Q1(B) (2M)	EXT (12/16M)	LESSON TOTAL
1	Enquiry 2.1: Plots and revolts at home	[/ 10]	[/ 2]	[/ 2]	[/ 12]	[/ 26]
2	Enquiry 2.2: Relations with Spain	[/ 10]	[/ 2]	[/ 2]	[/ 16]	[/ 30]
3	Enquiry 2.3: Outbreak of war with Spain, 1585–88	[/ 10]	[/ 2]	[/ 2]	[/ 12]	[/ 26]
4	Enquiry 2.4: The Armada	[/ 10]	[/ 2]	[/ 2]	[/ 16]	[/ 30]
KEY TOPIC 2 CUMULATIVE ASSESSMENT TOTALS		Do Now: [/ 40]	Q1(a): [/ 8]	Q1(b): [/ 8]	Ext: [/ 56]	[/ 112]

PEARSON EDEXCEL PAST PAPER PROVENANCE • COMPLETED EXAM YEAR LEDGER					
#	ENQUIRY / TOPIC FOCUS	Q1(A) FEATURE [2M]	Q1(B) FEATURE [2M]	EXT WRITING [12/16M]	YEAR DONE
1	Enquiry 2.1: Plots and revolts at home	Edexcel June 2018 (Q1b)	Edexcel June 2023 (Q1b)	Edexcel June 2018 (Q2)	[]
2	Enquiry 2.2: Relations with Spain	Edexcel June 2019 (Q1a)	Edexcel November 2021 (Q1b)	Edexcel June 2023 (Q3a)	[]
3	Enquiry 2.3: Outbreak of war with Spain, 1585–88	Edexcel June 2022 (Q1a)	Edexcel June 2019 (Q1b)	Edexcel November 2020 (Q2)	[]
4	Enquiry 2.4: The Armada	Edexcel November 2020 (Q1b)	Edexcel June 2024 (Q1a)	Edexcel June 2019 (Q3b)	[]

TEACHER FORMATIVE ASSESSMENT • WWW / EBI FEEDBACK		Effort Grade: []
WHAT WENT WELL (WWW): 	EVEN BETTER IF (EBI): 	
Teacher Signature: _____		Date: ____/____/2026

INTERACTIVE DIGITAL QUIZZING HUB • SCAN FOR INSTANT 20-QUESTION RETRIEVAL PRACTICE

Scan with smartphone camera to launch live self-marking quizzes

KT 2.1	KT 2.2	KT 2.3	KT 2.4	KT 2 VAULT
Plots and revolt... 20 Questions	Relations with S... 20 Questions	Outbreak of war ... 20 Questions	The Armada... 20 Questions	Master Quizzing 20 Questions